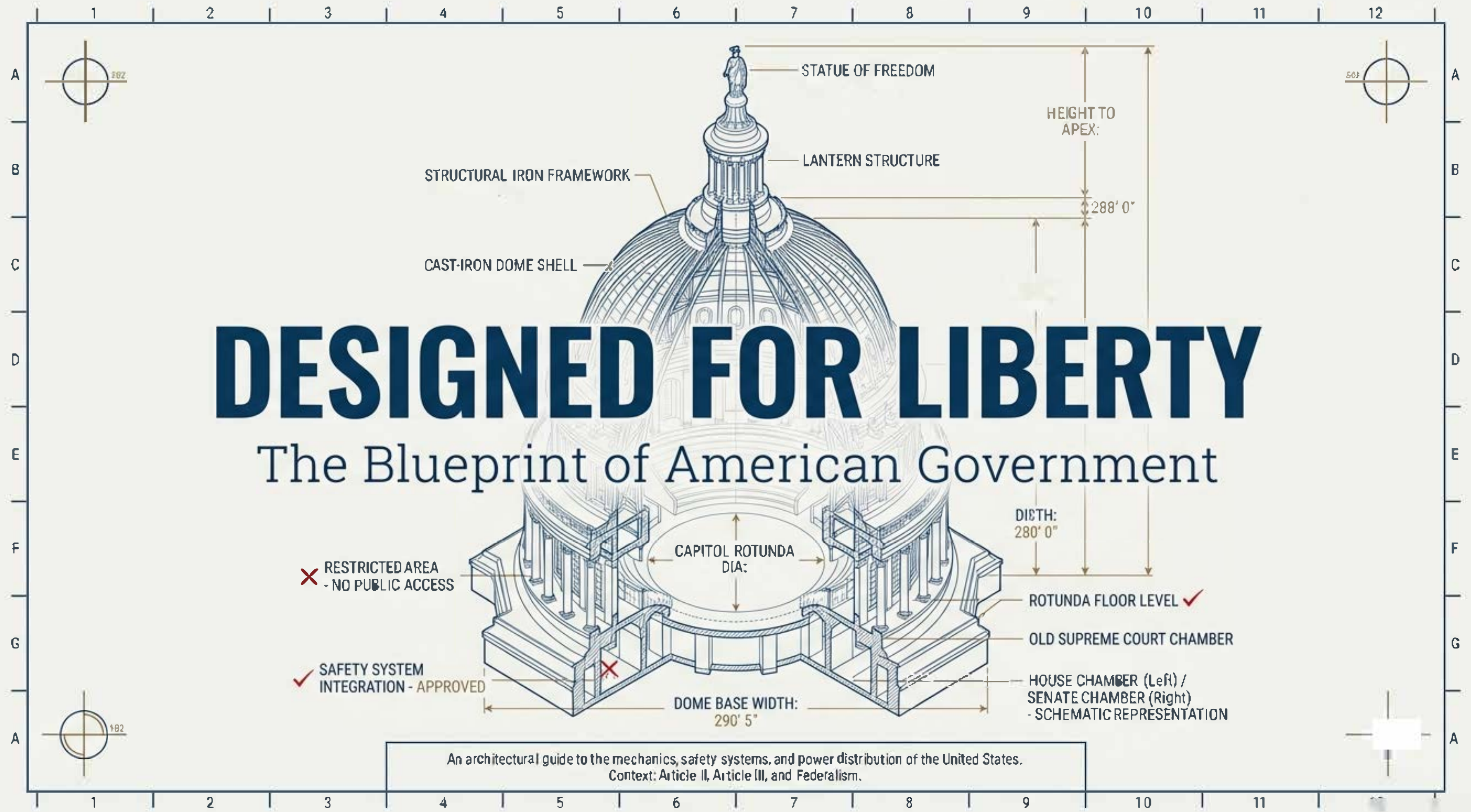




# DESIGNED FOR LIBERTY

The Blueprint of American Government

✗ RESTRICTED AREA  
- NO PUBLIC ACCESS

✓ SAFETY SYSTEM  
INTEGRATION - APPROVED

CAPITOL ROTUNDA  
DIA:

DOME BASE WIDTH:  
290' 5"

STATUE OF FREEDOM

LANTERN STRUCTURE

STRUCTURAL IRON FRAMEWORK

CAST-IRON DOME SHELL

HEIGHT TO  
APEX:

288' 0"

DIETH:  
280' 0"

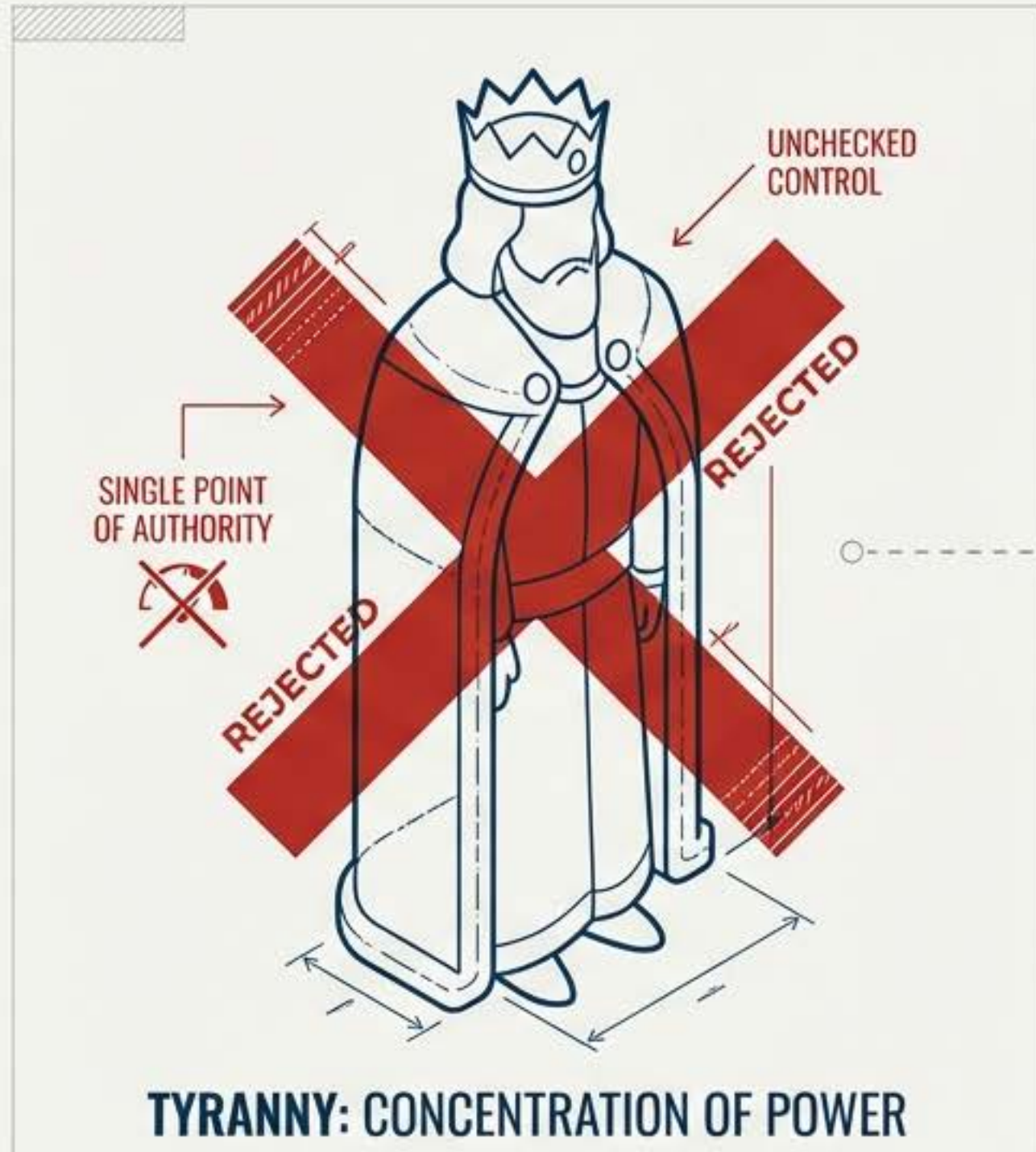
ROTUNDA FLOOR LEVEL ✓

OLD SUPREME COURT CHAMBER

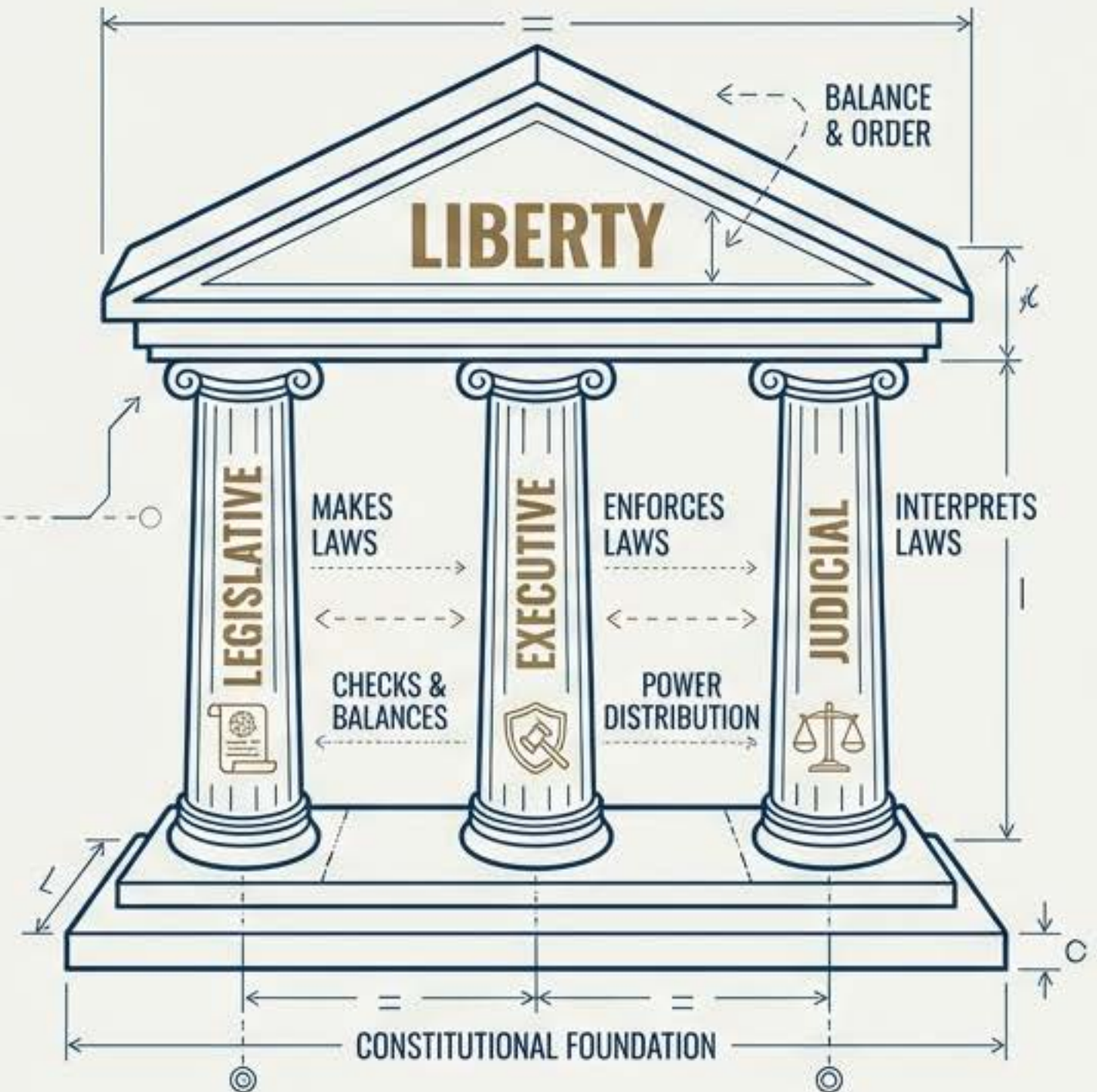
HOUSE CHAMBER (Left) /  
SENATE CHAMBER (Right)  
- SCHEMATIC REPRESENTATION

An architectural guide to the mechanics, safety systems, and power distribution of the United States.  
Context: Article II, Article III, and Federalism.

# THE ARCHITECT'S VISION



Influenced by Baron de Montesquieu's "The Spirit of Laws", the Framers separated power into three equal branches to prevent the rise of an all-powerful leader.

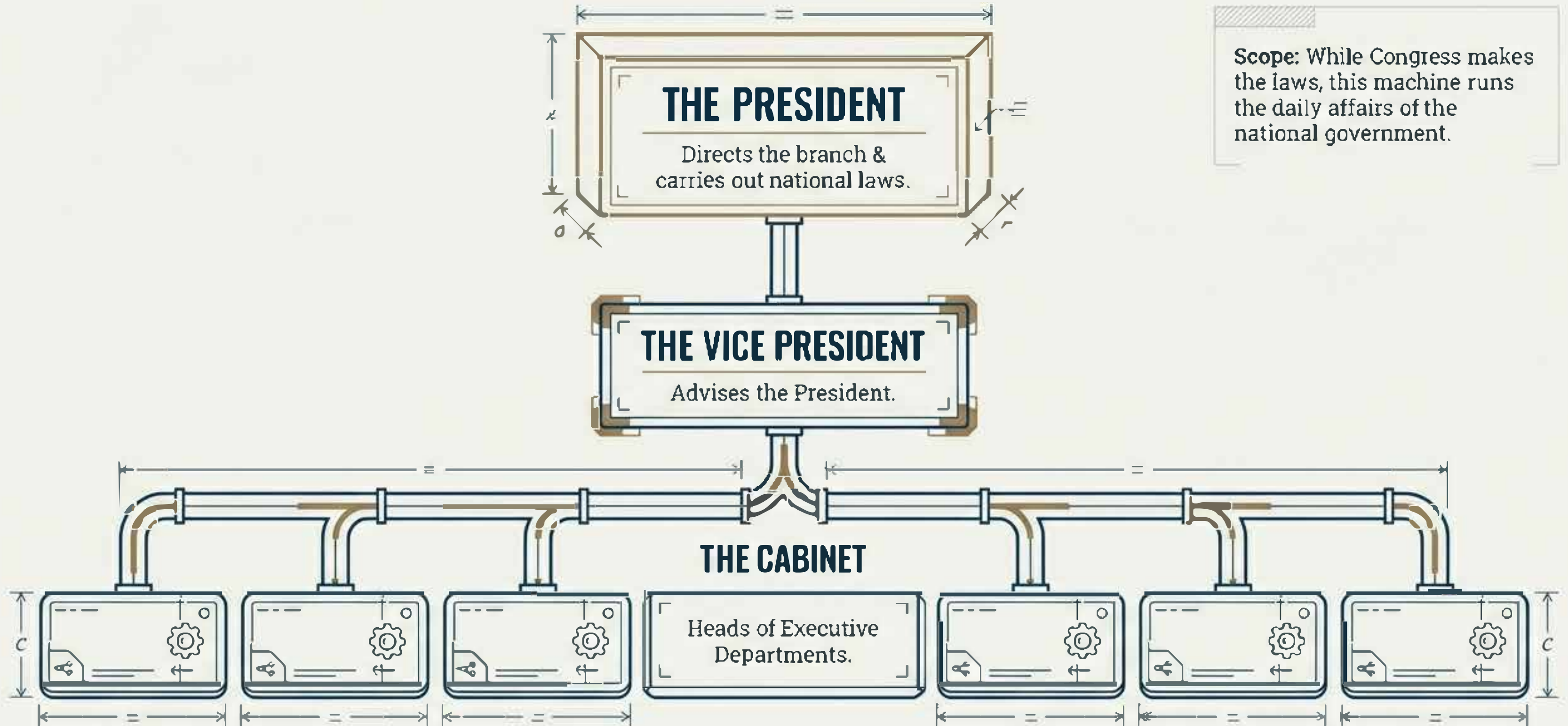


“Powers of government should be split... to prevent any branch from becoming too powerful.”

Am

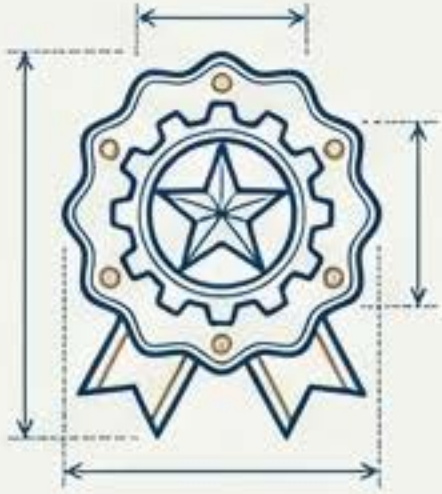


# THE EXECUTIVE MACHINE (ARTICLE II)



# THE MANY HATS OF THE PRESIDENT

## CHIEF EXECUTIVE



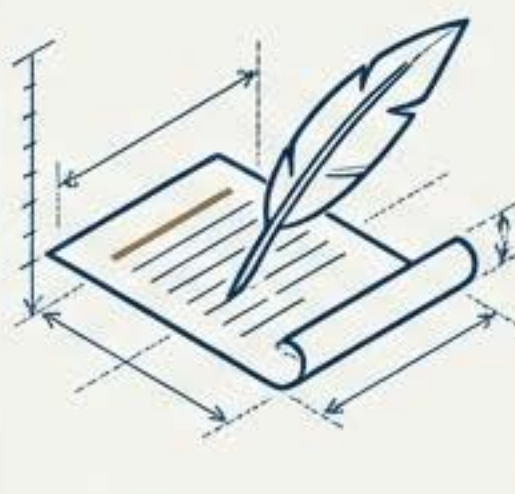
Enforces the nation's laws.

## COMMANDER IN CHIEF



Controls armed forces.

## CHIEF LEGISLATOR



Suggests new laws.

## CHIEF DIPLOMAT



Foreign policy & treaties.

## LIVING SYMBOL



Ceremonial head of state.



# THE ELECTION MECHANISM: ELECTORAL COLLEGE

**Term Limit:** 4 years,  
max 2 terms  
(22nd Amendment).

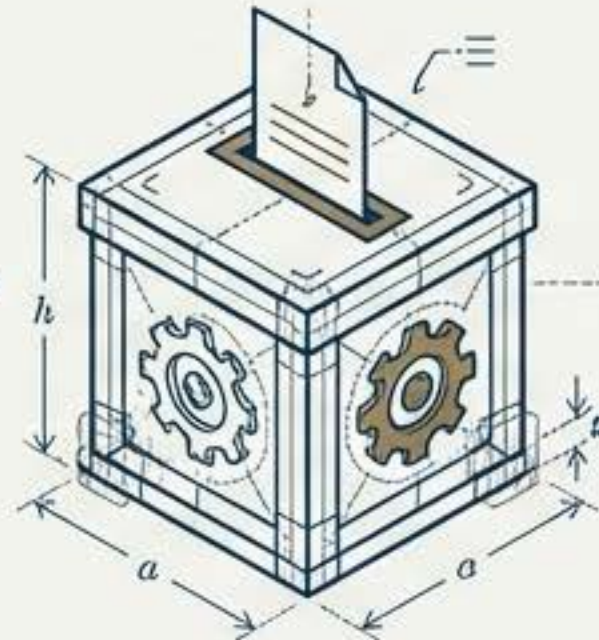
## POPULAR VOTE

Citizens vote for a  
slate of electors.



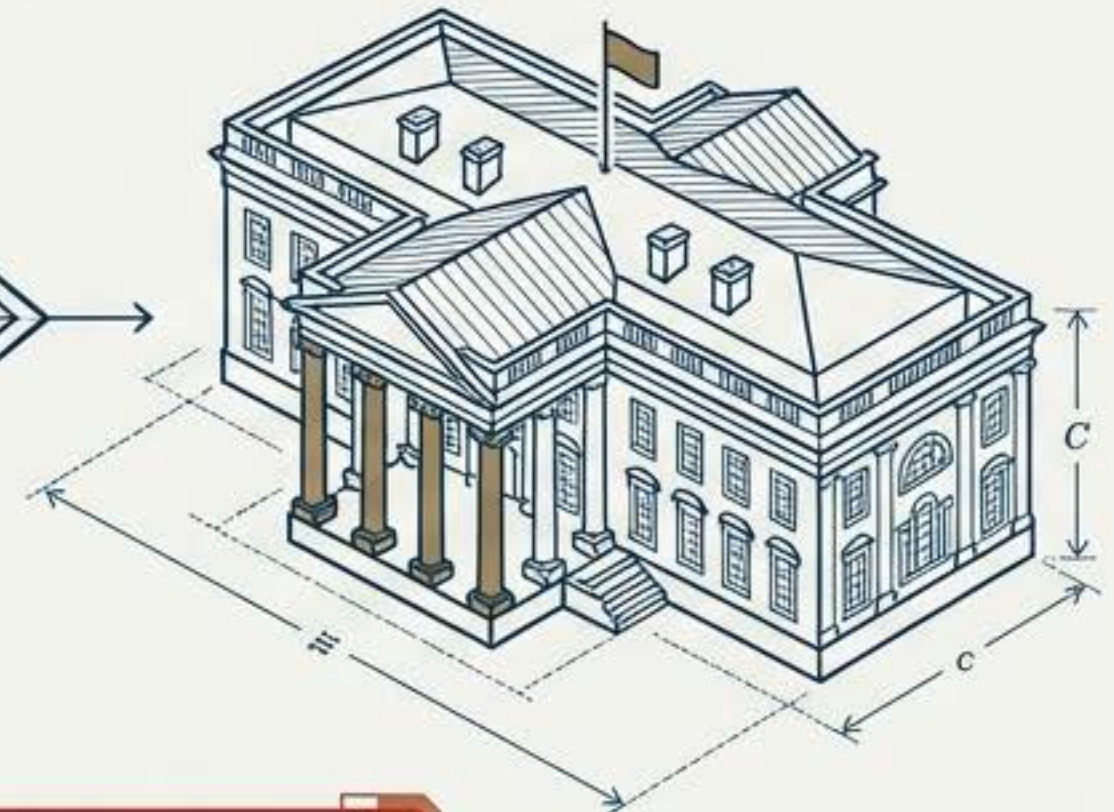
## THE ELECTORS

State Electors = Senators  
(2) + Representatives.



## THE PRESIDENCY

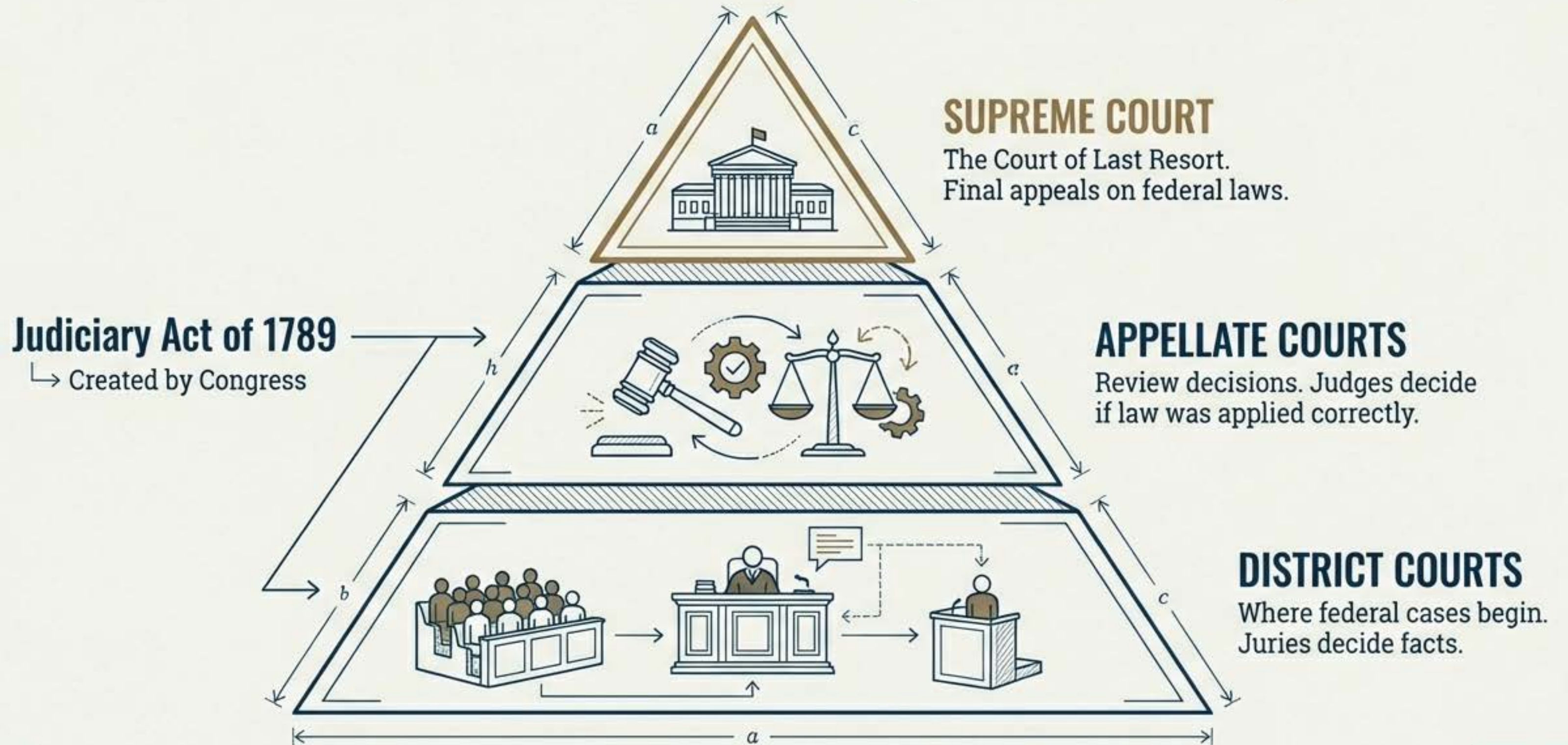
Candidate with majority  
of electoral votes wins.



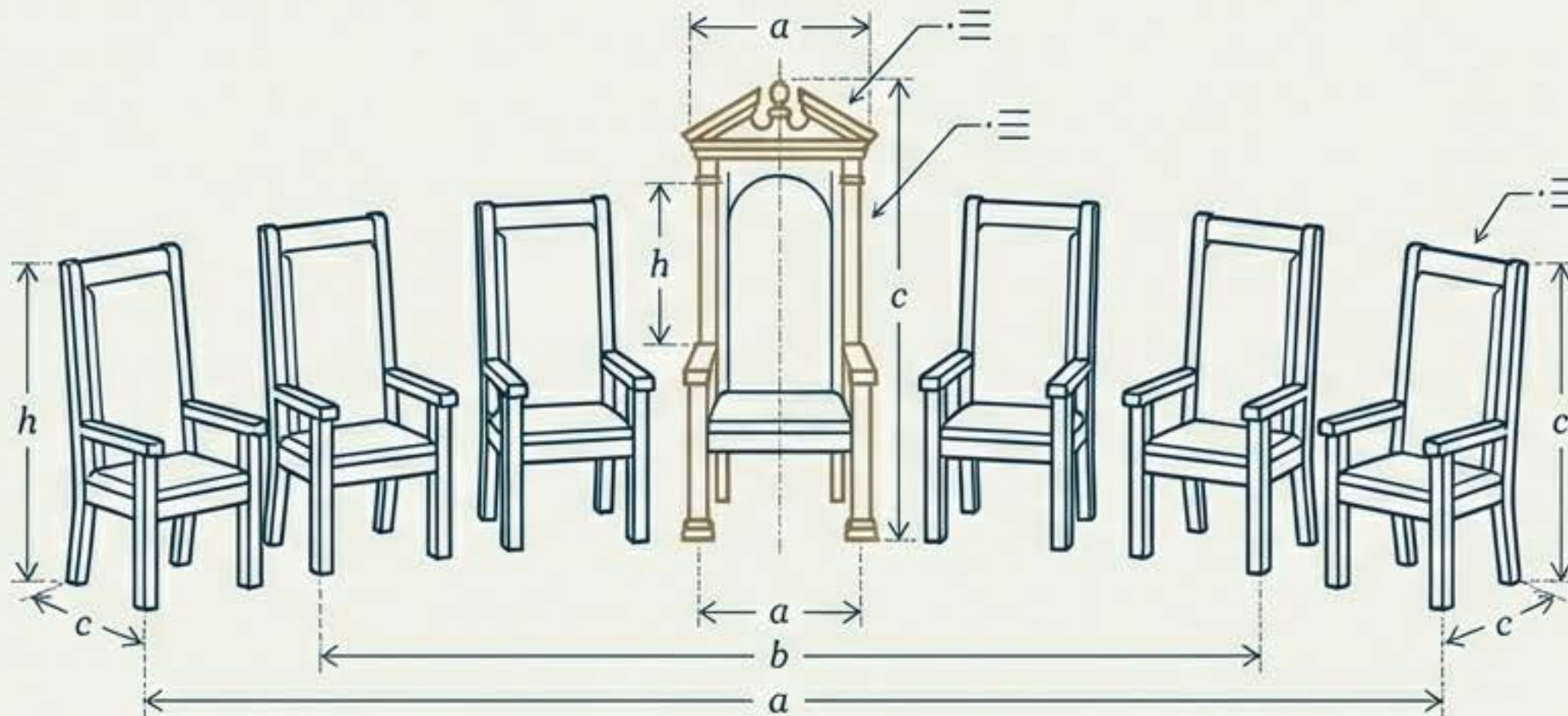
### THE WINNER-TAKE-ALL RULE:

In most states, the winner of the popular vote gets 100% of the electoral votes.  
A candidate can win the popular vote but lose the election.

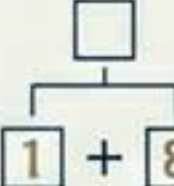
# THE JUDICIAL FILTER (ARTICLE III)

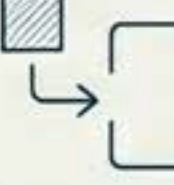


# THE HIGH COURT: SCOTUS

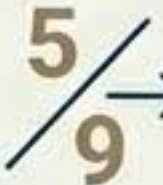


## SPECIFICATIONS

 **COMPOSITION:**  
1 Chief Justice,  
8 Associate Justices.

 **SELECTION:**  
Appointed by President,  
Confirmed by Senate.

 **TENURE:**  
Lifetime Appointment.

 **FUNCTION:**  
Hears <100 cases/year.  
Requires majority vote (5/9).

# THE POWER OF JUDICIAL REVIEW

## DEFINITION:

The power to declare acts of the President or laws passed by Congress as unconstitutional.



## ACT OF CONGRESS

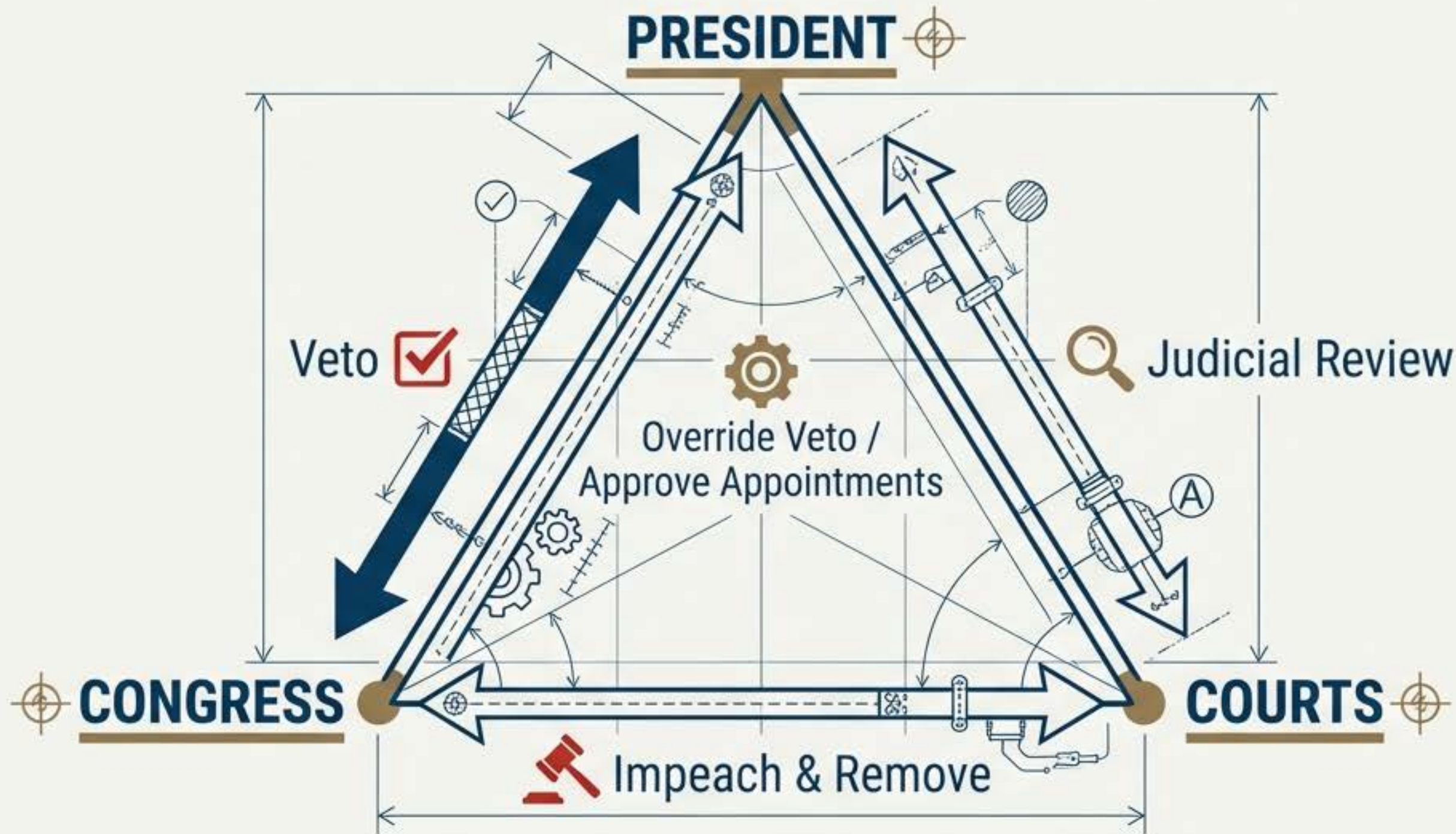
UNCONSTITUTIONAL

## ORIGIN:

Established by case law in 1803: Marbury v. Madison. This is the Judicial branch's primary check on power.



# THE SAFETY SYSTEM: CHECKS AND BALANCES

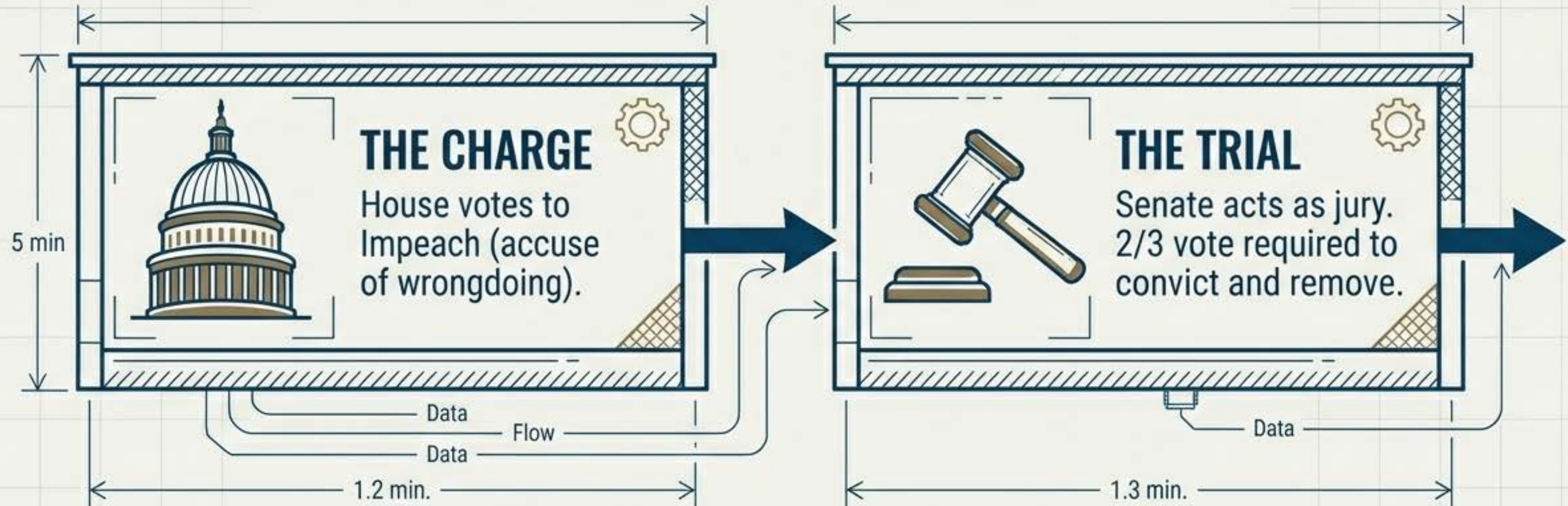


A web of accountability designed so that conflict is a feature, not a bug.

| BIBLIOGRAPHY |  |  |  |
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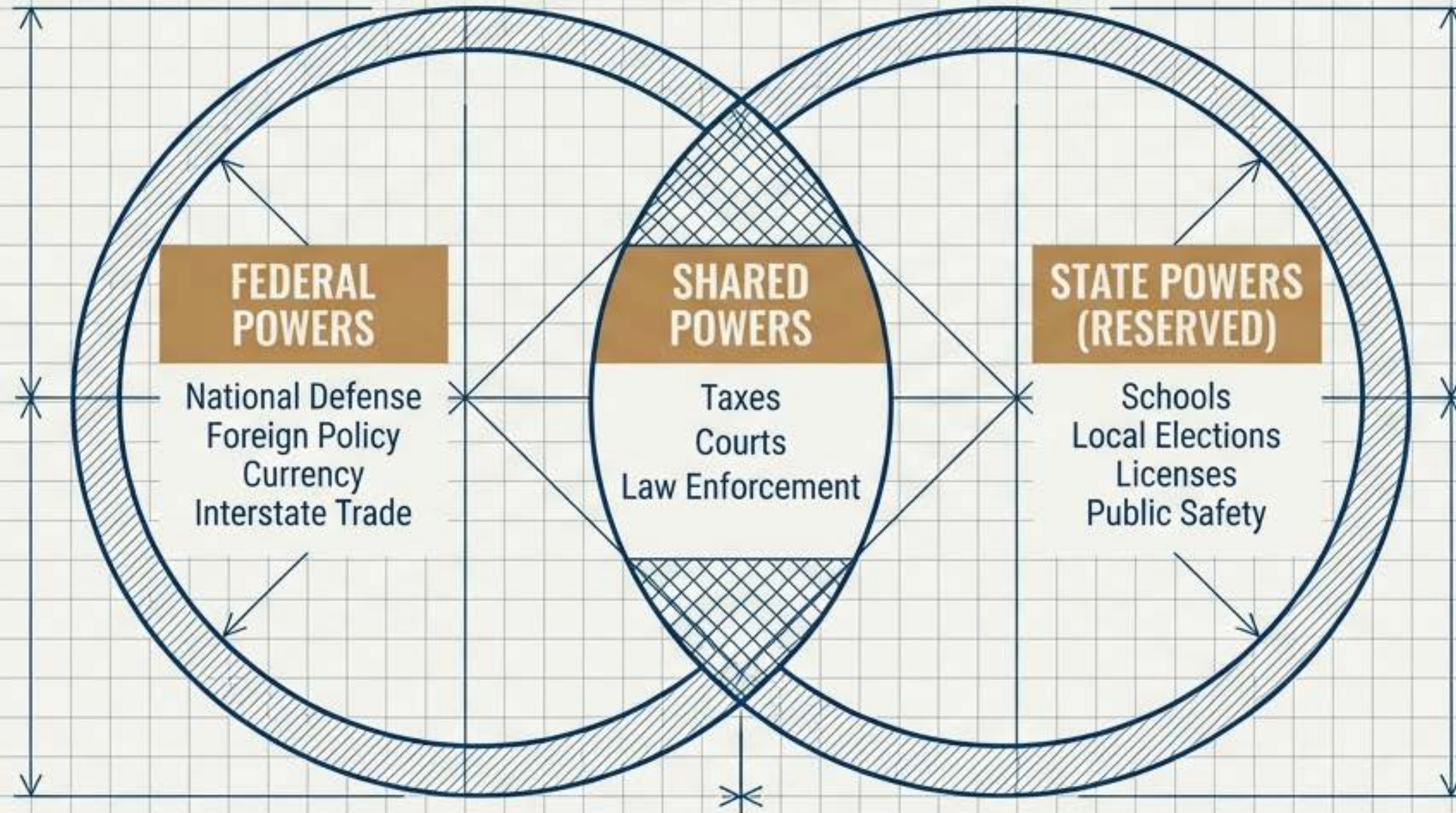


# THE ULTIMATE CHECK: IMPEACHMENT



Historical Context: Andrew Johnson and Bill Clinton were impeached by the House, but neither was convicted by the Senate. No President is above the law.

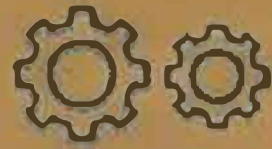
# THE DISTRIBUTION OF POWER: FEDERALISM



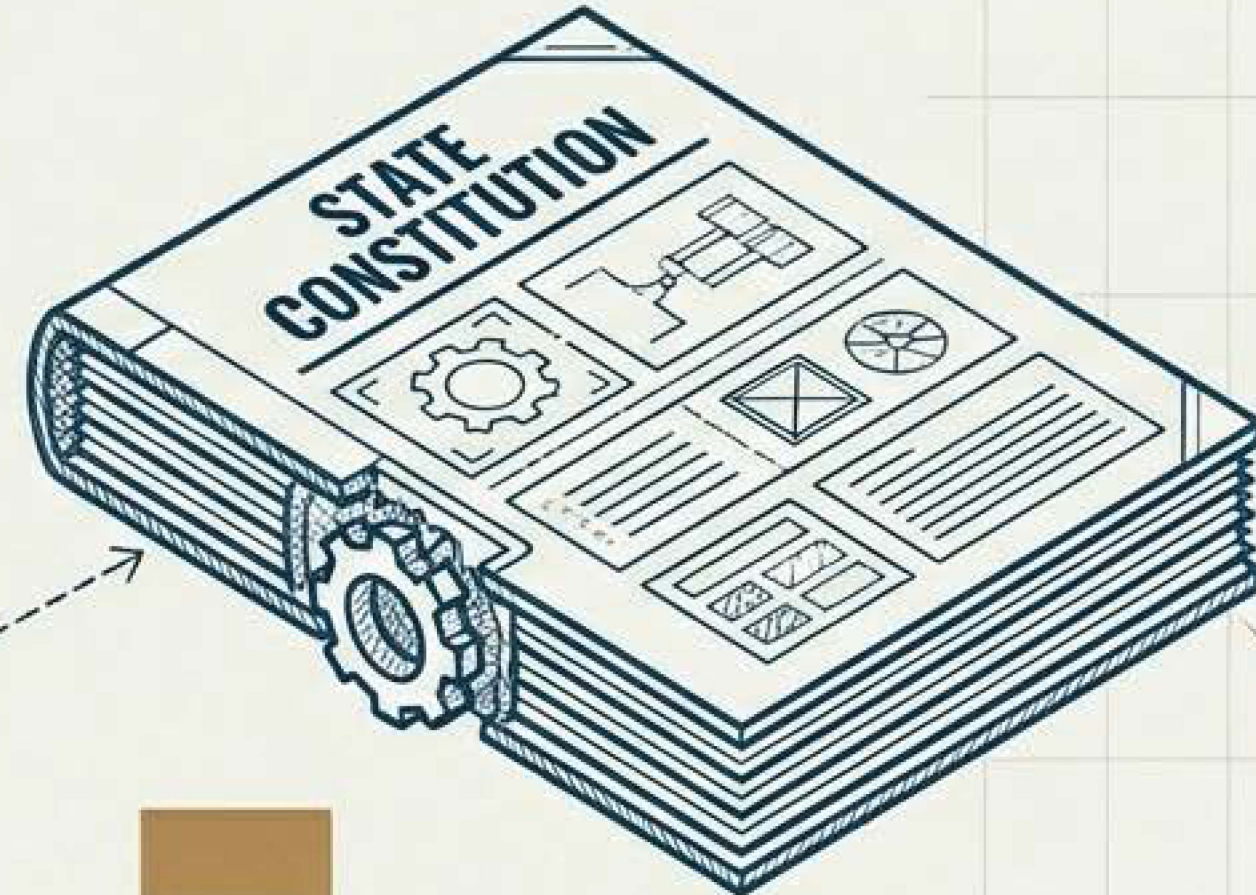
10th Amendment: Powers not delegated to the US...  
are reserved to the states.

|                     |      |            |
|---------------------|------|------------|
| Project             |      |            |
| Project Information |      | Wessotila: |
| Wolve               | Date | TPY:       |





# STATE FRAMEWORKS



- **MIRROR IMAGE:** States have their own Preamble, Bill of Rights, and 3 Branches.

- **MORE DETAIL:** State constitutions are longer and cover specific daily regulations.

- **CHANGE MECHANISM:** States allow "Constitutional Initiatives"—citizens can gather signatures to propose amendments directly.



|                     |      |            |
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| Project             |      |            |
| Project Information |      | Wessotila: |
| Weive               | Date | 1999       |



# THE DAILY APPLICATION: LOCAL GOVERNMENT

STATE LEVEL



COUNTY LEVEL



CITY LEVEL



Origin: Not mentioned in the US Constitution.  
Local governments (Cities, Towns, Counties) are created entirely by States.

**LOCAL GOVERNMENTS HAVE THE GREATEST IMPACT ON DAILY LIFE.**

Project

Project Information

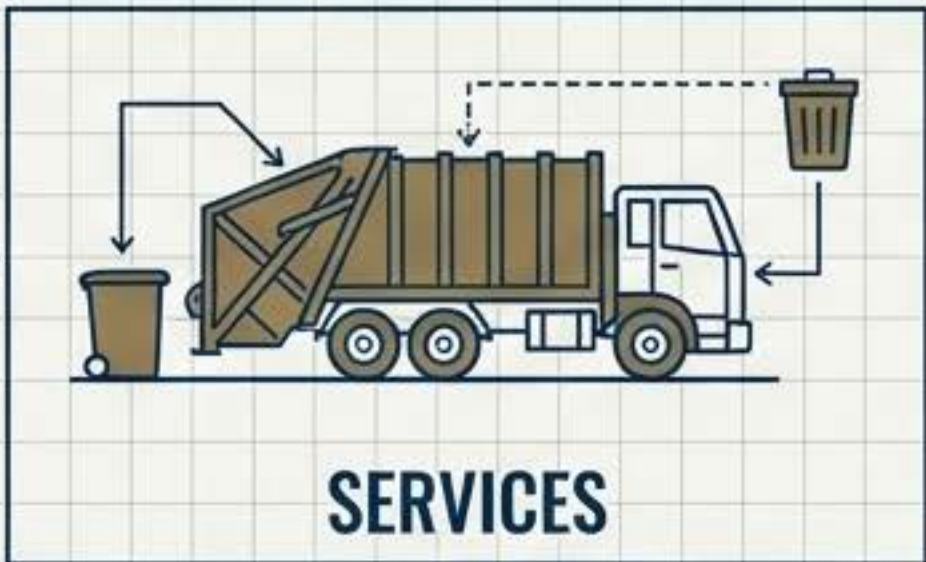
Date

Author

Title



# THE TANGIBLE GOVERNMENT



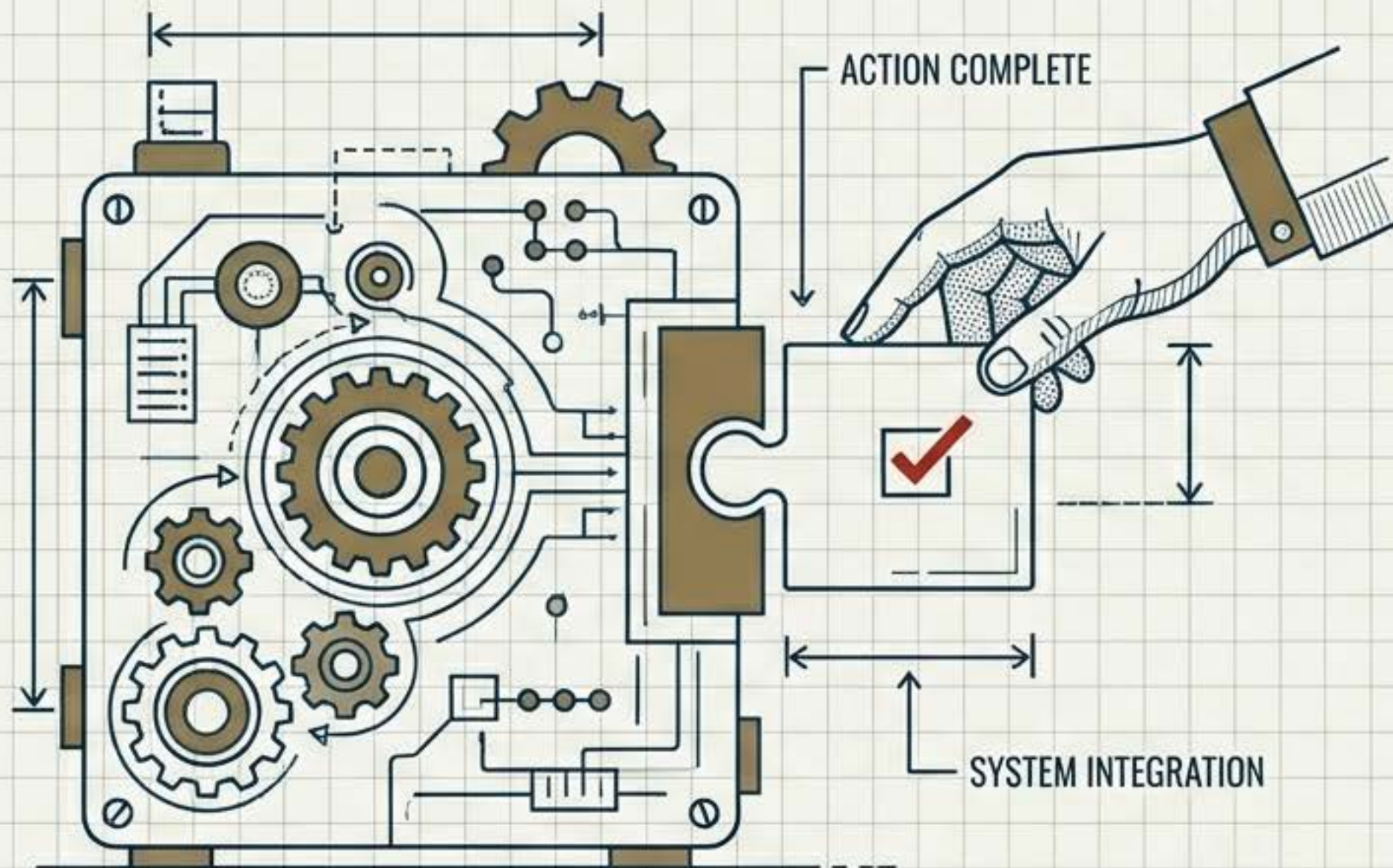
What taxes buy: Roads, sewers, police, libraries, and schools. States and Local gov—not the Feds—are responsible for public education.

|                                                                                                                                                                |                       |        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|
| Project                                                                                                                                                        | Date<br>June 15, 2022 | Author |
| Project information<br>Lorem ipsum dolor elit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. States and local gov—not the Feds—et vinceet in tenaon dolorconungus intenic. | Title                 |        |





# YOUR ROLE IN THE MACHINE



## CONSENT OF THE GOVERNED

- ☒ Serve on school boards.
- ☒ Vote on local budgets.
- ☒ Participate in initiatives.

Project

Project Information

Date

Author

The blueprint only functions when you participate.

